view of Hinduism that is at odds with everything Hinduism has sought to stand for, it seeks to refashion Hinduism as something it has never been. Indeed, as the economist Kaushik Basu has argued, it reveals the insecurity of Hindutva's cheerleaders that they want to remake their country and religion in the very image of the countries and religions they claim to detest.

Hinduism attaches importance to *pramana* (instruments of warranted inference) in the pursuit of *jnana*, or knowledge. As long as you can demonstrate the validity or rigour of your *pramana*, you are entitled to the specific belief structure you wish to adhere to. It is this feature, unlike other traditions that rely on revelation as claims to truth, that ensures Hinduism is more open to diversity of belief. My friend Keerthik Sasidharan suggested to me, in twenty-first-century terms, that Hinduism is analogous to an open-source operating system on top of which others can build applications to be deployed in the receptive hardware of human brains. All Hinduism demands before the formation of any belief is analytical and logical consistency. Even the existence of God is subject to this test. The Nietzschean formulation that God created Man and Man returned the compliment is anticipated more than a millennium ago in this verse by Udayanacharya, the tenth-century logician, addressed to the deity Jagannatha of Puri:

> *You're so drunk on wealth and power*
> *that you ignore my presence.*
> *Just wait: when the Buddhists come,*
> *your whole existence*
> *depends on me.*[6]

(Yet it should be said that Udayanacharya is the very sage credited with so roundly trouncing Buddhists in debate that Buddhism never dared to challenge Hinduism in India thereafter.)

A RELIGION WITHOUT FUNDAMENTALS

When I stood for the post of UN Secretary General in 2006, journalists quizzed me about the role my Hindu faith played in my worldview. I conceded that it was true that faith can influence one's conduct in one's career and life. For some, it is merely a question of faith in themselves;